Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting - October 19th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iolkp44NFQ8
Publication Date	2026-10-20T02:29:25Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 19, 2026
Body: Delaware County Commissioners

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding Officer Commissioner Reagan called the regular meeting to order at 9:01 AM 00:07:01, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance 00:07:15.
- **Attendance:**
  - Commissioners present: Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Bran, and Commissioner Reagan (Presiding Officer).
  - Members absent: None noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:07:15.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the October 5th meeting were approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner

Reagan - yes) 00:09:25.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:09:43 **Liability Insurance Coverage Bid Opening**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** One bid was received from USI Insurance (601 South High Street) for county liability insurance coverage. Staff noted that further analysis and explanation of the numbers would be provided to the commissioners.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to take under consideration by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:10:27.
- 00:10:40 **Owner-Occupied Rehabilitation (OKRA) Letter of Support**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Walters / ECRPD.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Walters presented a request for a letter of support for an OKRA grant application through the state. The county previously approved $500,000 in matching local funds, with an additional $37,000 required for inspections and radon testing outside the grant. The program aims to rehabilitate 20 to 25 homes in areas outside the city.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved and signed by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:13:23.
- 00:13:46 **Economic Development District Designation (EDDD) Letter of Support**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Walters / ECRPD.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on seeking an EDDD designation with the EDA for the region (Delaware, Grant, Blackford, and Jay counties) to leverage federal funding, support workforce initiatives, and address economic distress stemming from historical industrial downturns.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved and signed by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes, Commissioner Bran - yes) 00:15:48.
- 00:16:00 **Bridge 103 Replacement Award**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Dean Thomas.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Thomas presented bids for the Bridge 103 replacement project on 500 North over Mud Creek. Four bids were received, with Hoosier Pride Excavation identified as the apparent low bidder at $878,252.00. United Consulting verified paperwork. Funding source is the EDIT program.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Awarded to Hoosier Pride Excavation by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:17:01.

- 00:17:31 **JAG Grant Agreement**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Legal Counsel.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a JAG grant agreement for approximately $16,400. City council approval and agreement updates are required before funds can be disbursed; funds will be held pending these updates.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:19:02.
- 00:19:15 **2027 Calendars & Schedules**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and approval of 2027 schedules:
    - *Commissioner Meetings:* First and third Mondays (with holiday adjustments for Jan 19, July 6, Sept 7). Approved by voice vote (Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - no) 00:20:09.
    - *Holiday Schedule:* 13 observed holidays. Approved by voice vote (Commissioner Bran - no, Commissioner Henry - yes) 00:21:11.
    - *Storm Water Board Meetings:* First Monday following commissioner meetings (exceptions July 6 and Sept 7). Approved by voice vote (Mr. Brand - yes) 00:21:50.
    - *Unsafe Housing Building Authority Meetings:* Third Monday, with exception on Tuesday, Jan 19. Approved by voice vote (Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:22:16.
- 00:22:32 **AIA Justice Building Recognition / Client Authorization Release**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Architect.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding architectural recognition for the justice building remodeling project (addressing code compliance for unapproved utilized areas totaling just under $1.3 million). The architect requested submission for an award. The board reviewed a client authorization release, updating the representative's name to President Reagan.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:23:39.
- 00:24:00 **Nebo and Jackson Roundabout Property Transfer**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Bond Counsel.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request from Yorktown to take ownership of county property adjacent to the roundabout at Jackson and Nebo, including future maintenance obligations. Questions were raised regarding legal complications and outstanding bond debt associated with the installation of the roundabout. Bond counsel input is pending.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:24:57.
- 00:25:27 **Star Financial Bank Letter of Credit (Highway Garage Environmental Liability)**

    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Polk, Delaware County Treasurer.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal of a $15,000 letter of credit with Star Financial Bank required by the state regarding underground storage tank environmental liabilities at the highway garage. Fees total $250 annually ($75 application/insurance fee, $175 loan fee). It was noted that this setup avoids hundreds of thousands of dollars in direct remediation costs by utilizing the state's underground tank remediation fund.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:29:17.
- 00:30:00 **Jail Door Painting Bid**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers, Maintenance Superintendent.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Following instructions from the state jail inspector, 45 doors in the jail require professional spray-painting to address rust caused by cleaning issues and inmate wear. A bid of $27,450 was presented, to be funded out of EDIT 12.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote (Roll call: Unanimous/affirmative disposition recorded in transcript) 00:32:20.
- 00:32:32 **Ordinance 2026-023: Amending Title 4, Chapter 6 (Equal Access / HUD Fair Housing Language)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Legal Counsel.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Ordinance amending county code to match or exceed state and HUD fair housing requirements, a prerequisite for the OKRA grant. Substantive changes update the definition of "family" to include sexual orientation, gender identity, and marital status.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
        - Introduced and clarified: Approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:33:53.
        - Rules suspended: Approved by voice vote 00:34:32.
        - Adopted: Passed unanimously by voice vote 00:35:07.
- 00:35:25 **Ordinance 2026-24: Health Department Employee Stipends**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bane, Health Department Administrator.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrator sought an ordinance for staff stipends approved by county council during budget approvals. It was noted that wage, stipend, and bonus matters fall under the fiscal authority of the county council, and state board of accounts feedback is pending.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to deny request approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Henry - yes) 00:36:41.
- 00:37:07 **Ordinance 2026-25: Junk Vehicles Ordinance**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff.

    - **Deliberation Summary:** Following previous discussions and modifications regarding penalties to clean up the county, the amended ordinance was presented.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced as amended by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Bran - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:38:07.
- 00:38:23 **Ordinance 2026-26: County Travel Policy**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / HR.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Final form of the countywide travel policy following months of review and feedback from department heads and elected officials.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote 00:39:27.
- 00:39:44 **Ordinance 2026-15: Amending Chapter 35 (Grass and Weeds)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Collaboration between health, building, and legal departments. Upon adoption, enforcement flowcharts, notices of violation, and contractor authorization forms will be established. Becomes effective 10 days after publication.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote 00:41:13.
- 00:43:32 **Ordinance 2026-20: Personnel Handbook Amendment (PTO & Health Insurance Deductions)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Updates to PTO policies and health insurance premium deductions.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by voice vote (Roll call included Commissioner Henry - yes) 00:41:54.
- 00:42:06 **Ordinance 2026-21: Broadband Ready Community Designation**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes permit and adoption procedures for broadband development projects to apply for designation under Indiana Code 5-28-28.5.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:42:32.
- 00:42:45 **Ordinance 2026-22: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Amendment (6600 Block North Schaffer Road, Hamilton Township)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Planning Commission.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Reclassifies an abandoned railroad strip in Hamilton Township. Received a unanimous favorable recommendation from the planning commission.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes) 00:39:51 *(Note: timestamp reflects final adoption sequence)*.
- 00:44:22 **Resolution 2026-14: Land Bank Properties**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel / Staff.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Follow-up on land bank property conveyances. Due to deed chain search complications, problematic properties are being removed so the

balance of the request can proceed.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by voice vote (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 00:45:00.
- 00:45:12 **Resolution 2026-15: Countywide Consolidation of Restricted/Settlement Funds**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Legal.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a procedure for the county and participating towns to pool restricted settlement funds for broader countywide programs. Towns are generally in favor.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote 00:46:06.

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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 01:03:12 **Resident Speaker:** Expressed community concerns regarding rumors of data centers planned for the east side near the reservoir (citing sound/light pollution and carbon output) and announced a community town hall scheduled for October 26th at 6:30 PM at the Oakwood Retreat Center (Selma). The speaker noted advocacy for a moratorium (referencing Madison County) through the group “Protect Delaware County Now” to ensure community safety and proper regulation.

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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Department & Staff Reports:**
    - **Human Resources (Lee Royal):** Announced CANRX prescription program entry monitoring, open enrollment dates (Nov 10<U+2013>13) featuring unbundled benefits (medical, dental, vision separated), retiree premium rate updates (effective Jan 1), and office Halloween trick-or-treating guidelines (Friday, Oct 30, 2:00<U+2013>4:00 PM for family members/grandchildren).
    - **OIS (Kyle Johnson):** Notied installation of a new lobby information display screen and plans for future justice center screens.
    - **Veteran Services (Brian Wilson):** Highlighted an increase in Delaware County VA compensation and pension funds from $26.84M in 2020 to $43.87M in 2025 (a 63.44% increase).
    - **Highway Department (Tommy Hun & Dean Thomas):** Reported on completion of 21 miles of paving, 39.6 miles of chip and seal, 51 culvert installations, interlocal agreements (Cowan and Eaton), FEMA storm damage estimates (~$110k immediate response; ~29 areas totaling nearly $500k), and ongoing work on 700 East and Summer Hill.
- **Financial Approvals:**

    - Payment of Claims ($866,906.85): Approved by voice vote (Commissioner Bran - no, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 01:02:05.
    - Payment of FARP ($3,625): Approved unanimously by voice vote 01:02:13.
    - Payroll ($1,100,585.30, October 21, 2026): Approved unanimously by voice vote 01:02:30.
- **Board & Commissioner Announcements:**
    - Commissioner Bran reported on AEP transmission project open houses, emphasizing that the project falls under the jurisdiction of the Indiana Utility Regulatory Commission (IURC) rather than local commissioner authority, and addressed recent social media discourse and threats.
    - Commissioner Reagan announced high voter turnout and encouraged early voting.
- **Adjournment / Recess:** The meeting was recessed to the next regular meeting on November 2nd, 2026, at 9:00 AM, following a voice vote on the motion to recess (Roll call: Commissioner Henry - yes, Commissioner Reagan - yes) 01:23:51.

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